schema changes to the database, but I won't be going into great depth on any topics.

NOTE For an in-depth look at EF Core, I recommend *Entity Framework Core in Action*, 2nd ed., by Jon P. Smith (Manning, 2021). Alternatively, you can read about EF Core on the Microsoft documentation website at https://docs.microsoft.com/ef/core.

Section 12.1 introduces EF Core and explains why you may want to use it in your applications. You'll learn how the design of EF Core helps you iterate quickly on your database structure and reduce the friction of interacting with a database.

In section 12.2 you'll learn how to add EF Core to an ASP.NET Core app and configure it by using the ASP.NET Core configuration system. You'll see how to build a model for your app that represents the data you'll store in the database and how to hook it into the ASP.NET Core DI container.

NOTE For this chapter I use SQLite, a small, fast, cross-platform database engine, but none of the code shown in this chapter is specific to SQLite. The code sample for the book also includes a version using SQL Server Express's LocalDB feature. This version is installed as part of Visual Studio 2022 (when you choose the ASP.NET and Web Development workload), and it provides a lightweight SQL Server engine. You can read more about LocalDB at http://mng.bz/5jEa.

No matter how carefully you design your original data model, the time will come when you need to change it. In section 12.3 I show how you can easily update your model and apply these changes to the database itself, using EF Core for all the heavy lifting.